



CASE STUDY #004 · SUNDAY · INDEPENDENCE WEEK

Skyroot. India's first private orbit, over 90% made at home.

Series · Case Study (Sun) **Date** · 09 Aug 2026 **Subject** · Skyroot Aerospace

Framework · Self-reliance is a moat

01 Carousel caption (posts 08:00 IST)

For 50 years, reaching orbit in India was a government job. Two ex-ISRO scientists just broke that open.

Skyroot Aerospace, founded by Pawan Chandana and Bharath Daka, sent its Vikram-1 rocket to orbit in July 2026. That made India only the third country, after the US and China, with a private company launching to orbit. And over 90% of the rocket is made in India.

This isn't just a cool startup. It's strategic self-reliance. Space runs communications, defence, navigation and imaging, and India no longer has to rent foreign rockets to reach its own orbit.

The lesson: self-reliance isn't a slogan, it's a moat. Build the hard capability at home and you own the future instead of renting it.

💬 Tag a founder building India's future.

📖 Sources: SpaceDaily, Wikipedia, SiliconIndia

👉 Follow @statupsutra for a startup teardown every day.

#startup #madeinindia #skyroot #spacetech #startupindia

SEO Keywords (one line, comma-separated, for captions, alt text, cross-posting, YouTube/blog)

skyroot aerospace, skyroot vikram-1, india private rocket, indian space startup, made in india rocket, pawan chandana, bharath daka, space tech india, india space unicorn, private orbital launch india, atmanirbhar bharat space, strategic autonomy india, isro private startup, spacetech startup india, self reliance india, indian deeptech, skyroot funding, india space independence, startupsutra case study, make in india

★ Story behind the pick (Independence Week theme)

Week 4 leans into freedom / self-reliance for India's Independence Day. Skyroot is the literal embodiment: a strategic capability (orbital launch) that was a state monopoly for 50 years, now built privately and over 90% at home. The lesson generalises beyond space, own the hard, home-grown capability instead of importing it.



02 Reel caption (evening · single reel, reversal hook)

REEL · REVERSAL HOOK

Everyone thinks reaching orbit is a government job. Two ex-ISRO scientists just did it privately, over 90% made in India.

Skyroot Aerospace sent its Vikram-1 rocket to orbit in July 2026, making India the third country, after the US and China, with a private company reaching orbit. Vertically integrated, its own engines, 3D-printed parts, an Indian cost base.

Space is strategic. Owning a home-grown launch capability is independence in the most literal sense.

💬 Tag a founder building India's future.

📖 Sources: SpaceDaily, Wikipedia.

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#startup #madeinindia #skyroot #spacotech #startupindia

03 Alt text 7 slides

1. Case Study, Skyroot. For 50 years reaching orbit in India was a government job; two ex-ISRO scientists just did it privately.
2. Snapshot: Skyroot Aerospace, based in Hyderabad, founders Pawan Chandana and Bharath Daka (ex-ISRO), reached orbit with Vikram-1 in July 2026, India's first space unicorn at a \$1.1 billion valuation.
3. The breakthrough: India opened space to private players in 2020 and Skyroot reached orbit first, making India the third country ever, after the US and China, with a private company launching to orbit.
4. The real edge: over 90 percent of the rocket is made in India, with its own engines, 3D-printed parts and avionics, vertically integrated and not import-dependent, strategic autonomy not just a cost play.
5. The business: a \$1.1 billion valuation, about \$60 million raised from Sherpalo and GIC, 1,000-plus employees, targeting one launch a month.
6. Why it matters: space is strategic, running communications, defence, navigation and imaging, and a home-grown launch capability means India isn't renting foreign rockets to reach its own orbit.
7. The takeaway: self-reliance isn't a slogan, it's a moat; build the hard capability at home and you own the future instead of renting it. Follow @statupsutra, Case Study on Sundays.

04 Hashtags, Stories & timing

CORE

#startup #madeinindia #skyroot #spacotech
#startupindia

EXTENDED

#atmanirbharbharat #isro #deeptech
#independenceday #makeinindia #entrepreneurship
#india #rocket #spacotech

Comment engine (week-3 still 0 comments): switch to tag-a-founder, pin "Tag a founder building India's future."
Stories: teaser "two ex-ISRO scientists broke a 50-year monopoly 🚀" → poll "India's next frontier: Space or Chips?".
Tag @skyroot.aerospace.

LOCKED SCHEDULE (IST)

TIME	ASSET
08:00	Carousel, slides 1 to 7
~18:00	Story teaser
20:00	Reel (reversal hook)
20:05	Story poll + pin comment

One reel only. Reply to every comment within the hour.